

7.0 CLOSE ASSAULT

Undisrupted combatants that are not marked Fired may Close Assault adjacent (white font CAF units may assault same hex, see 7.3) combatants in the Close Assault Phase. Combatants whose Close Assault Firepower (CAF) is succeeded by an asterisk may not initiate Close Assault but may defend. It is NOT mandatory to attack adjacent combatants, but it IS mandatory to participate (either as an attacker or defender) in a Close Assault against same-hex enemy combatants (see 7.3). To participate in the attack the target hex terrain type must not be prohibited to the attacker, nor may the attacker attack across a prohibited hexside. The side with the initiative conducts the first Close Assault, and then the players alternate Close Assaults. A combatant may not initiate more than one Close Assault in a turn, but may be the target of more than one Close Assault in a turn. When conducting a Close Assault, you must attack all combatants in the hex.

All qualifying adjacent combatants may attack the target hex (exception, see 7.3). The player initiating the Close Assault is the attacker. Add the CAF of all attacking combatants and compare the attacking total to the CAF of the combatants in the target hex. Express the result as an odds ratio – attacking combat factors versus defending combat factors. For example, 8 attacking combat factors versus 4 defending factors would be 2-1 odds. Fractions are dropped. So, 10 attacking combat factors versus 4 defending combat factors would still be 2-1 odds, but 12 attacking factors versus 4 defending is 3-1 odds. Disrupted defenders defend with $\frac{1}{2}$ of their total CAF (fractions dropped), but always with at least a CAF of 1. This odds ratio corresponds to a column on the Close Assault Table (CAT). Modify the column as per the TEC. If both Leg and AFVs are defending a hex, use the most beneficial TEC modifier to the defender. Roll 1d10 and consult the CAT.

The results are displayed as possible hits. The number to the *right* of the slash is the number of possible hits inflicted on the defender, the number to the *left* is the number of possible hits inflicted on the attacker.

The defender rolls 1d10 for each possible hit. Compare each die roll to the target's morale. As in 2.3, a roll that is less than or equal to the morale succeeds, negating a hit. The remaining hits are applied to the target (if only one) or evenly distributed among the targets in the hex if there is more than one. If evenly distributing the hits among two targets ensure that both targets receive one hit before any receives two. If there is an odd number of hits, randomly determine which combatant receives the extra hit.

If same-side combatants of differing morale are involved in a Close Assault, use the higher morale to resolve all hits (exception, Zombies, 12.1).

Units may not attack in Assault Combat at odds lower than 1-3 (exception, Zombies).

Place a Fired marker on combatants that participate in a Close Assault.

7.1 Retreat and Advance after Assault

Combatants

If the defender receives more hits than the attacker, it must retreat one hex, and the attacker may occupy the vacated hex. Only Eligible Combatants (EC) that participated in the attack may advance into a vacated hex.

The defenders' retreat must be in a general direction away from the attacking forces. If the defender must retreat into a hex containing two friendly combatants, it must continue retreating and both friendly combatants are disrupted (retreating unit unaffected). A defender may not retreat into an enemy's hex. A defender may not retreat into an enemy's hex. A retreating defender or stack of defenders takes an additional hit if retreating into a ZOC. If a defender cannot retreat, it is eliminated. If the defender is eliminated the undisrupted attackers may also advance into the vacated hex. The defenders may never advance, even if the attackers are eliminated.

7.2 Flanking

If the assaulting combatants are attacking the defender from two, non-adjacent hex sides, the defender is flanked. Shift the odds on the CAT one column to the right.

7.3 Same Hex Assaults

Several combatants enter their enemies' hex to conduct Close Assault. These combatants are identified either by the white font that they use for their CAF or the Bloodthirsty ability icon (which allows them to attack from either in-hex or adjacent to hex). These combatants include Lycans, Vampires, Zombies, and Champions such as Tentani and combatants with the Bloodthirsty ability.

- Units may only enter a hex with an enemy combatant if the entering unit has a white font CAF, the Bloodthirsty ability, or all non-friendly units in the hex to be entered do not have a CAF.

For example, Lycans with their CAF of 16 can/must enter any enemy hex to conduct Close Assault. By the

same token any unit may enter a Refugees' hex as they have no CAF.

- EC may fire on enemy combatants entering their hex in the Movement Phase (Opportunity Fire). Such fire receives the Short-Range column shift regardless of the attacking unit's HEF range block color (including black) and font color. Combatants disrupted by such an attack, retreat to the hex from which they entered into the Close Assault hex.
- Assault combat must occur between co-located units in the Close Assault Phase.
- The side with the first unit to enter an enemy occupied hex becomes the attacker in the assault. When alternating assaults in the Close Assault Phase this person must designate the hex as their assault at some point in the phase.
- There are no terrain modifications for either side in co-located assaults.
- Friendly units adjacent to a hex being assaulted by units in the hex may not assist in the assault.

For example, a Clan Militia unit adjacent to a hex in which a Lycan is attacking an American Infantry unit may not assist in the assault. Of course they may indirectly assist by firing at the target of the assault (hopefully disrupting it) in the fire phase before the Lycan move into the hex to assault.

Mark says. What's the logic? Well the usual Long Road assault between adjacent units represents a close range (25-50 meters) fight, not necessarily hand-to-hand combat. Units in the hex, such as Lycan or Vampires, do represent hand-to-hand combat. It would be difficult, if not impossible, for units to fire into the hex for fear of hitting their own people.

- Determine the winner of the assault normally. Co-located units that are defeated retreat from the hex. Defeated attackers return to the hexes from which they entered the assault hex. Defenders attempt to retreat away from attackers, as per the rules under (7.1)
- If the attackers are unable to muster 1-3 odds (exception: Zombies), they are disrupted and must retreat from the hex. In such case, retreating Champions take 1 hit.
- You may not fire out of or into a jointly occupied hex.
- Close Assault against hexes containing 2 opposing forces (possible in 3-sided scenarios) attack both groups of units. In this case losses are assessed equally and randomly.
- You cannot move out of a jointly occupied hex, except when forced to by a combat result.
- Units in a jointly occupied hex do not have a ZOC.